Samuel Lado

Faculty of Economics and Social Sciences & EQUALITAS,
Universitat Internacional de Catalunya
Carrer de la Immaculada, 22
08017 Barcelona
slado@uic.es
https://samuellado.github.io/

Personal information

Complete name: Samuel Lado Franco

Date of birth: November 11, 1997

Citizenship: Spanish

Researcher profiles

ORCID ID: 0000-0002-7290-7598

Scopus ID: 57394624000

Researcher ID: KMA-2181-2024

Employment and affiliations

Faculty of Economics and Social Sciences, Universitat Internacional de Catalunya 2026–
Assistant Professor

Institute for Advanced Family Studies (IESF) 2026–
Affiliate member

Economics of Inequality and Poverty Analysis (EQUALITAS) 2024–
Affiliate member

Education

ESOMAS, University of Torino May-July 2026
Postdoctoral research visit
Host: Dr Ambra Poggi

Universitat de Girona 2021–2025
PhD, Economics
Title: *Essays on the effects of school-meal programmes*
Advisor: Dr Sara Ayllón
Examination committee: Prof. Dan-Olof Rooth (Swedish Institute for Social Research, Stockholm University), Prof. Carla Haelermans (Maastricht University), Dr Angus Holford (Institute for Social and Economic Research, University of Essex)

Institute for Social and Economic Research, University of Essex January-April 2025
Visiting PhD student
Host: Prof. Birgitta Rabe

Universitat Oberta de Catalunya 2020–2021
M.Sc., Economic Analysis

Universitat de Girona 2015–2020
B.Sc., Economics

Universitat de Girona 2015–2020
B.Sc., Business Management and Administration

Research interests

Poverty, Inequality, Applied Microeconomics, Public Policy Evaluation, Labour Economics, Public Economics

Work in progress

Universal free school meals and work incentives: Lessons from England.

The causal effects of mandatory gender equality plans (with Sara Ayllón and Bernat Remolins).

Do minimum wages change non-wage working conditions? Evidence from collective agreements (with Ferran Elias, Rubén Pérez-Sanz, and Marc Riudavets-Barcons).

Teleworking and childcare across Europe: Is there a childcare digital divide? (with Sara Ayllón, Pablo Brugarolas, and Enza Simeone).

Journal publications

Ayllón, S.; Brugarolas, P.; Lado, S. (2026). New estimates for inequality of opportunity in Europe using elastic net algorithms, *Applied Economics Letters*, 33(8): 1256-1260.

Ayllón, S.; Holmarsdottir, H. B.; Lado, S. (2023). Digitally deprived children in Europe, *Child Indicators Research*, 16: 1315-1339. Dissemination: Digital Generation Blog.

Ayllón, S.; Lado, S. (2022). Food hardship in the US during the pandemic: What can we learn from real-time data?, *Review of Income and Wealth*, 68(2): 518-540.

Chapters in edited volumes

Ayllón, S.; Lado, S.; Symeonaki, M. (2024). Digitally disengaged and digitally unconfident children in Europe in *Understanding the everyday digital lives of children and young people*, ed. H. B. Holmarsdottir, I. Seland, C. Hyggen, M. Roth. Palgrave Macmillan, pp. 27-55 (chapter 2).

Ayllón, S.; Brugarolas, P.; Lado, S. (2024). ICT use and children's self-reported life satisfaction in *Understanding the everyday digital lives of children and young people*, ed. H. B. Holmarsdottir, I. Seland, C. Hyggen, M. Roth. Palgrave Macmillan, pp. 239-279 (chapter 9).

Working papers

Ayala-García, A.; Lado, S.; Serra-Saurina, L.; Silva, J. I. (2026). Labour market flows and the child penalty: Evidence from Spanish administrative records, SSRN Electronic Journal [submitted].

Guixeras, X.; Garriga, A.; Ballester, R., Lado, S.; Velazco, J. (2026). Assessing the impact of urban sprawl on the public water supply in Spanish municipalities (2008–2016), mimeo [R&R Utilities Policy].

Ayllón, S.; Lado, S. (2025). More than just lunch: School-meal subsidies and language proficiency, IZA Discussion Paper no. 17631, EQUALITAS Working Paper no. 80 [R&R Journal of Population Economics]. Dissemination: The Social Observatory, 'La Caixa' foundation, Nada es Gratis, El Diari de l'Educació.

Ayllón, S.; Lado, S. (2025). The causal impact of school-meal programmes on children in developed economies: A meta-analysis. IZA Discussion Paper no. 18042, EQUALITAS Working Paper no. 90 [R&R Journal of Economic Surveys].

Ayllón, S.; Brugarolas, P.; Lado, S. (2023). The level of inequality of opportunity in Spain: An estimation using Artificial Intelligence, Instituto de Estudios Fiscales. Media coverage: El Confidencial, El Confidencial.

Reports

Arcarons, A.; Ayllón, S.; Blanquer, M.; Giamello, C.; Lado, S.; Lafuente, M.; Salvador, G.; San Vicente, J. (2026). School Meals Case Study: Spain [Estudio de caso sobre alimentación escolar: España], London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine.

Ayllón, S.; Brugarolas, P.; Lado, S. (2022). La transmisión intergeneracional de la pobreza y la desigualdad de oportunidades en España, Ministerio de Derechos Sociales y Agenda 2030. Media coverage: ABC, El Correo, Las Provincias, Europa Press. [in Spanish]

Sánchez, C.; Marquès, P.; Lado, S.; Bikfalvi, A. (2022). Guia de bones pràctiques per a la igualtat de gènere a la indústria agroalimentària, Departament d'Acció Climàtica, Alimentació i Agenda Rural, Generalitat de Catalunya. [in Catalan]

Sánchez, C.; Marquès, P.; Lado, S.; Lloveras, N. (2021). La dona a la indústria alimentària a Catalunya, Departament d'Agricultura, Ramaderia, Pesca i Alimentació, Generalitat de Catalunya. [in Catalan]

Other publications

Seland, I.; Aldrich, R.; Ayllón, S.; Lado, S.; et al. (2022). Understanding children and young people as digital citizens, DigiGen Working Paper Series no. 12.

Parsanoglou, D.; Mifsud, L.; Ayllón, S.; Lado, S.; et al. (2022). Combining innovative methodological tools to approach digital transformations in leisure among children and young people, DigiGen Working Paper Series no. 9.

Ayllón, S.; Barbovschi, M.; Casamassima, G.; Lado, S.; et al. (2020). ICT usage across Europe. A literature review and an overview of existing data, DigiGen Working Paper Series no. 2.

Ayllón, S.; Casamassima, G.; Drossel, K.; Eickelmann, B.; Hyggen, C.; Lado, S.; Port, S.; Broekstra, N. (2021). Digital diversity across Europe, DigiGen Policy Brief.

Blanco, M.; Ventura, J; Lado, S.; Sastre, M.; Callado, J. F.; Xabadia, A.; Marquès, P. (2019). Girona 100 SA 2019, KPMG i Càtedra Cambra de l'Empresa Familiar. [in Catalan]

Participation in research projects and contracts

2026-2029: Inequality and public policy: The role of education, gender and technology, Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation.

2023-2025: Inequality and opportunities: The role of food insecurity, education and pro-social preferences, Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation.

2022-2025: Subsidised school meals and child well-being, Social Research Call 2022 'La Caixa'.

2022-2025: Economic analysis of public policies, Grup de Recerca Reconeguts, AGAUR (2021SGR570).

2022-2023: Inequality of opportunity in Spain: An estimation using artificial intelligence, Instituto de Estudios Fiscales.

2022: Explotació descriptiva de dades sobre les accions finançades pel programa Temps per Cures, Institut Català d'Avaluació de Polítiques Públiques (Ivàlua) (PI).

2022: Transmisión intergeneracional de la pobreza, Dirección General de Diversidad Familiar y Servicios Sociales, Ministerio de Derechos Sociales y Agenda 2030.

2020-2023: DigiGen. The impact of technological transformations on the digital generation, DT-TRANSFORMATIONS-07-2019, HORIZON 2020, European Commission.

2021: Guia de bones pràctiques per a la igualtat de gènere a la indústria agroalimentària, Departament d'Acció Climàtica, Alimentació i Agenda Rural.

2020: La dona a la indústria alimentària a Catalunya, Departament Agricultura, Ramaderia, Pesca i Alimentació, Generalitat de Catalunya.

Conferences and seminars

2026: IESF Internal Seminar (scheduled), UIC Internal Seminar, XIV Workshop on Public Policy Design: Labor Markets, Institutions, and Inequality, Seminar at the Department of Political Science — Universitat de Barcelona, Barcelona Applied PhD Seminar — Universitat Pompeu Fabra, XII EQUALITAS Workshop, UPF Memorial Day to Honor Ghazala Azmat (scheduled, attendance only), 1st Seminar on Economics, Institutions and History — Universitat de Girona, EQUALITAS Seminar Series, Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education (LESE) Conference.

2025: X Congreso de la Red Española de Política Social (REPS), XI EQUALITAS Workshop, Meeting of the Society of the Economics of the Household (SEHO), CESifo/ifo Junior Workshop on the Economics of Education, Fourth Catalan Economic Society Conference (CESC), ISER Junior Applied Research Group Official Network (JARGON) — University of Essex, Seminar at the Institute for Social and Economic Research (ISER) — University of Essex, Seminar at the Institut Català d'Avaluació de Polítiques Públiques (Ivàlua).

2024: Symposium of the Spanish Economic Association (SAEe), PAPERSS Seminar Series — Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Meta-Analysis of Economics Research Network Colloquium (MAER-Net), 37th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE), 2nd young AERNA day (attendance only), XXXI Meeting on Public Economics, AQR Lunch Seminar — Universitat de Barcelona, X EQUALITAS Workshop, Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education (LESE) Conference.

2023: VI Seminar for New Academic Researchers (SNAR), Meta-Analysis of Economics Research Network Colloquium (MAER-Net) (attendance only), Third Catalan Economic Society Conference (CESC) (attendance only), Third Winter Workshop of the Catalan Economic Society (attendance only), Workshop on 'Comedores Escolares para la Infancia Europea: Garantizar una Alimentación Saludable a la Infancia en la Unión Europea' (attendance only), Workshop on 'Retos en Programas de Garantía de Ingresos' (attendance only), XIII Workshop in Public Policy Design (attendance only).

2021: XXVIII Meeting on Public Economics, XXIII Applied Economics Meeting, V Conference of Predoctoral Researchers of the Universitat de Girona, XIV Labour Economics Meeting, Symposium of the Spanish Economic Association (SAEe).

Other presentations and scientific meetings

Presentation in the 'Thesis in 4 minutes' competition, 2025

Presentation in the second 'Subsidised school meals and child well-being' stakeholder meeting, 2024

Presentation of the project 'Subsidised school meals and child well-being' to the Advisory Board, 2023

Presentation of the project 'Transmisión intergeneracional de la pobreza y la desigualdad de oportunidades en España' to the Ministerio de Derechos Sociales y Agenda 2030. Link to the video presentation, 2023

Presentation in the first 'Subsidised school meals and child well-being' stakeholder meeting, 2023

Presentation of the project 'Transmisión intergeneracional de la pobreza' to the Red de Inclusión Social (RIS), 2023

Attendance to the following scientific meetings of the 'DigiGen' project: Leicester (2022), Cluj-Napoca (2022), Brussels (2022), Girona (2021), Paderborn (online, 2021), Athens (online, 2020)

Workshop, meetings, and seminar organization

Organiser support for the fourth Catalan Economic Society Conference (CESC), 2025

Organiser of the second 'Subsidised school meals and child well-being' stakeholder meeting, Barcelona, 2024

Organiser of the 'VII Conference of 'Pre-doctoral Researchers', Universitat de Girona, 2024

Organiser support for the third Catalan Economic Society Conference (CESC), 2023

Organiser of the first 'Subsidised school meals and child well-being' stakeholder meeting, Barcelona, 2023

Organiser of the scientific meeting of the 'DigiGen' project, Universitat de Girona, 2021

Research activities

Summer school: The economics of poverty and inequality: Global challenges in the 21st century (Universitat de Barcelona School of Economics), 2024

SAEe PhD school in economics: Matched employer-employee data: Theory and applications (Universidad de Salamanca), 2023

10th Course and open seminar on compositional data analysis (Universitat de Girona), 2023

Summer school: Microeconometrics and policy evaluation – Modern estimation methods and machine learning (Paris School of Economics), 2023

Regression discontinuity design (Mixtape Sessions), 2023

Machine learning and causal inference (Mixtape Sessions), 2022

Summer school: First steps in the elaboration of a dynamic microsimulation model (InGRID-2 project), 2022

Quantitative methods for the analysis and evaluation of public policies with Stata (Universidad Internacional de Andalucía), 2021

Experimental approach in labor and development economics (XIV Labour Economics Meeting), 2021

Summer school: Reducing risk of poverty in the EU: Data and policies, Centre for European Policy Studies (InGRID-2 project), 2021

Winter school: Data for monitoring poverty and vulnerabilities in Europe, Centre for European Policy Studies (InGRID-2 project), 2020

Teaching

Microeconomics, Universitat Internacional de Catalunya (2026/2027)

Industrial Organisation, Universitat Internacional de Catalunya (2026/2027)

Descriptive Data Analysis, Universitat Internacional de Catalunya (2026/2027)

Business Statistical Inference, Universitat Internacional de Catalunya (2026/2027)

Applied Economics Instruments, Universitat de Girona (2021/2022, 2022/2023, 2023/2024, 2024/2025, 2025/2026)

Macroeconomics, Universitat de Girona (2023/2024)

Topics in Applied Economics, Universitat de Girona (2021/2022, 2022/2023)

International Economics, Universitat de Girona (2021/2022)

Social Policies in the European Union, Universitat de Girona (2020/2021)

Political Economy, Universitat de Girona (2020/2021)

Markets and Behaviour, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (Affiliated Teaching staff) (2021/2022, 2022/2023, 2023/2024, 2024/2025, 2025/2026)

Microeconomics, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (Affiliated Teaching staff) (2021/2022)

Referee service

Journal of Economic Surveys

Previous academic and professional appointments

Department of Economics, Universitat de Girona 2025–2026
Postdoctoral research fellow

Department of Economics, Universitat de Girona 2022–2025
Predoctoral research fellow

Department of Economics, Universitat de Girona 2020–2022
Research assistant

Department of Economics, Universitat de Girona 2020–2022
Associate lecturer

Faculty of Economics and Business, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya 2021–2026
Affiliated Teaching staff

Family Business Chair, Universitat de Girona 2020–2021
Research assistant

Ajuntament de Quart 2019–2023
Councillor for Sports (2019-2020), Youth, and Communications

Peixos Puignau 2019–2020
Accountant and clerical assistant

Grants, awards, and scholarships

Awarded 3rd place in the 'Thesis in 4 Minutes' competition, Universitat de Girona, 2025

Mobility scholarship from the Universitat de Girona for a research visit to the Institute for Social and Economic Research (ISER), University of Essex, 2024

SAEe 2024 PhD student grant, Fundación Ramón Areces and the Spanish Economic Association, 2024

PDI Grant, Consell Social de la Universitat de Girona, 2024

FPU Doctoral Scholarship, Ministerio de Universidades, 2022

FI SDUR Doctoral Scholarship, AGAUR, 2022

Best undergraduate thesis award, Faculty of Business and Economic Sciences, Universitat de Girona, 2020

Languages and skills

Languages: Spanish (native), Catalan (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Galician (beginner)

Coding: Stata, R, Python (basic knowledge), LaTeX

References

Dr Sara Ayllón
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Universitat de Girona
sara.ayllon@udg.edu

Prof. Birgitta Rabe
Professor of Economics
Institute for Social and Economic Research (ISER)
University of Essex
brabe@essex.ac.uk

Dr Jose Ignacio Silva
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Universitat de Girona
jose.silva@udg.edu

Dr Angus Holford
Senior Research Fellow
Institute for Social and Economic Research (ISER)
University of Essex
ajholf@essex.ac.uk